RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Backend Engineer | Python, Go & Distributed Systems
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PROFILE

Backend engineer and engineering leader with 21 years of experience building large-scale backend systems in Python, Go and C++. Designed and led services and platforms, including systems serving 50M+ users and an entitlement service handling 120k requests per second at peak. Hands-on engineer who continues to code weekly, primarily on internal tooling in recent years.

CORE SKILLS

Backend development: Python, Go, C++, Django, Flask, FastAPI, Tornado, asyncio, REST APIs
Data and messaging: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Pub/Sub
Cloud and infrastructure: GCP, GKE, BigQuery, AWS (EC2, S3), Kubernetes, Terraform
Reliability and engineering: Distributed systems design, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, architecture reviews, technical hiring, people management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH, Munich | 2019 - 2026 (Aug)

- Led the platform organisation of 5 teams, 45 engineers and 5 engineering managers, responsible for identity, playback API, billing integration and developer platform.
- Drove migration from a Python 2 monolith to approximately 60 Python and Go services on GKE; playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Reduced cloud spend by 31% (EUR 4.2M per year) through rightsizing, committed use discounts and an internal cost dashboard.
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.
- Grew the organisation from 18 to 45 engineers and ran more than 200 interviews.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH | 2015 - 2019

- Served as technical lead for the playback API, using Python, Tornado, an internal FastAPI-like framework, Cassandra and Redis.
- Designed a Go and Cassandra entitlement service handling 120k requests per second at peak.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart | 2010 - 2015

- Built backend services for fleet telematics, ingesting GPS data from 300k vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS and RabbitMQ.
- Led a team of 6 developers on the route-history product.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe | 2005 - 2010

- Developed C++ and Python for industrial data acquisition software on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for 8 years.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent MSc) in Computer Science | Rhine Valley University | 2005

LANGUAGES

German (native), Italian (native), English (fluent)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & TALKS

- “Running Python at 100k rps” - EuroPython-style conference talk, 2018
- “Cost is a feature” - internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023